

BEYOND THE CREST

The Donohue Company — Document 03

A Daytime Drama

Founded: Monday, April 3, 1939, Atlanta, Georgia

Founder: Alexander Donohue (b. Friday, March 3, 1916)

Valuation: \$10 trillion

Corporate Profile

Field	Detail
Legal name	Donohue Enterprises, Inc., doing business as The Donohue Company
Ticker	NYSE: DNHU (Class A common)
Controlling shareholder	Donohue Global Holdings, Inc. (private family holding company)
Industry	Multinational mass media & entertainment conglomerate
Headquarters	Donohue Tower, 1939 Peachtree Street NE, Midtown Atlanta, GA 30309
Founder	Alexander Donohue (1916–2006), with Simone Donohue (1910–2014)
Chairman	Victor Donohue (2006–present)
CEO	Natasha Bullock (2006–present)
President & COO	Marc-Anthony Bullock (named Mon, Jan 5, 2026)
Market capitalization	\$10.0 trillion (world's most valuable company)
Annual revenue (FY2025)	\$1.62 trillion
Net income (FY2025)	\$318 billion
Employees	1.14 million in 96 countries
Audience reach	Some Donohue product touches an estimated 6.1 billion people a month
Philanthropy	The Donohue Foundation (endowment \$300 billion+), chaired by Joan Donohue. It spares no expense.

The Founder

Alexander Donohue was born on Friday, March 3, 1916, above a barbershop on Auburn Avenue, “Sweet Auburn,” then the richest Black street in America. His father was a Pullman porter who brought home every newspaper left behind on the trains. His mother took in laundry and read those papers aloud at night. By 12, Alexander was selling newspapers on street corners, and he noticed that none of the papers he sold told his neighbors' stories. By 20 he was setting type at a Black-owned print shop. At 23 he started his own paper.

He met **Simone Batiste**, a New Orleans jazz singer six years his senior, when she played the Top Hat Club on Auburn Avenue in 1938. She bankrolled the first printing press with her savings from three years of nightclub tours. They married on Saturday, June 7, 1941. Alexander called her “my first investor and my only partner,” and meant it.

History of The Donohue Company

1939–1949: The Beacon

- Monday, April 3, 1939: *The Atlanta Beacon* publishes its first edition, four pages printed on Simone's press in a back room on Auburn Avenue. Circulation: 1,100.

- 1942–1945: The Beacon sends Black war correspondents to Europe and the Pacific. Circulation passes 200,000, and “The Beacon” becomes the most trusted Black newspaper in the South.
- 1947: Launches *Crown*, a Black lifestyle and society magazine.

1950–1959: Radio, Records & Pictures

- 1951: Donohue buys WDON-AM, putting Black voices on Atlanta radio: gospel on Sunday, jazz on Friday, the news every hour.
- 1953: **Donohue Pictures** is founded, first to make films for Black audiences and then to break them into white theaters.
- 1958: Alexander and Simone found Belmont Crest (see Document 04).
- 1959: Donohue Pictures' *Sweet Auburn Serenade* becomes the first Black-produced film to top the national box office.

1960–1975: The Movement Years

- 1961: **Donohue Records** launches in Atlanta: soul, gospel, and the sound of the South. It becomes Motown's great Southern rival.
- 1960s: The Beacon covers the civil rights movement from the inside. Alexander quietly bankrolls bail funds and bus fare, and the FBI opens a file on him in 1963.
- 1966: Victor Donohue, 20, becomes a matinee idol in *Midnight on Peachtree*.
- 1969: Victor marries his co-star Joan Mercer, and the company's first family becomes America's first family of entertainment.
- 1972: Launches WDON-TV, a UHF station, the seed of **Donohue Broadcasting Group**. Victor originates the lead in the Broadway musical *Sweet Chariot*.

1976–1989: Victor's Empire

- Monday, January 5, 1976: Alexander names his younger son Victor CEO over his elder son Theodore and becomes Chairman. Theodore walks out of the boardroom and doesn't come back.
- Monday, October 16, 1978: **IPO** on the New York Stock Exchange. Donohue Enterprises lists Class A shares and keeps super-voting Class B shares in the family.
- 1981: Launches the **Crown Network**, a 24-hour cable channel, and starts buying stations in 30 markets.
- 1987: A hostile takeover of Paragon Pictures, a century-old Hollywood studio. The trade press calls it “the Atlanta Invasion.”

1990–2005: Going Global

- 1990: Signs the first **Crown License** with Smilley Corporation, the master licensing deal that puts Donohue characters and brands on Smilley products (see Document 06).
- 1995: Buys the Continental Broadcasting Company, a national broadcast network, and rebrands it **DBC**.
- 1998: Opens the first **Donohue Worlds** theme park in Orlando and takes a 4% strategic stake in Smilley Corporation.

- 2001: Launches Beacon News Network (BNN), a 24-hour global news channel.
- 2004: Acquires Crown Comics and its universe of heroes.

2006–2019: The Natasha Era

- Monday, January 9, 2006: Alexander Donohue dies at 89. Victor becomes Chairman and Natasha becomes CEO at 34.
- 2009: Donohue Games is founded; its *Kingdom of Kora* franchise becomes the best-selling game series of the decade.
- 2012: Donohue Global Holdings takes a 12% strategic stake in Blackwater Security International (see Document 05).
- 2016: **Donohue+** streaming launches worldwide and reaches 100 million subscribers in 14 months.
- 2018: Donohue Worlds opens in Tokyo, Paris, and Dubai.
- 2019: Market capitalization passes \$1 trillion for the first time.

2020–2026: The \$10 Trillion Company

- 2020: Donohue+ passes 500 million subscribers during the pandemic, and Donohue Live pioneers virtual concerts and Broadway streams.
- 2021: Donohue Studios AI launches, with the **Donohue Creator Guarantee**: every AI tool pays human artists royalties.
- 2023: Market cap passes \$5 trillion. Marc-Anthony wins his Oscar for a Donohue Pictures film.
- Wednesday, December 31, 2025: The stock closes at \$250 a share. Market cap: **\$10.0 trillion**.
- Monday, January 5, 2026: Series premiere. Victor's Succession Covenant names Marc-Anthony President & COO.

Divisions (2026)

Division	Leader	What it is
Donohue Pictures (incl. Paragon)	Natasha Bullock (oversight)	The world's No. 1 film studio
Donohue Broadcasting Group	Martin Olson, President	DBC network, the Crown Network, 212 local stations
Donohue+		Streaming, 1.3 billion subscribers
Donohue Records & Publishing		No. 1 music label and catalog
Beacon Media		<i>The Atlanta Beacon</i> , BNN news, <i>Crown</i> magazine, book publishing
Donohue Worlds		Theme parks, resorts, cruise line
Donohue Games		Games, esports, <i>Kingdom of Kora</i>
Donohue Live		Concerts, Broadway (Donohue Theatricals), live events

Division	Leader	What it is
Donohue Consumer Licensing	Reports to Marc-Anthony	Licenses Donohue IP worldwide. Home of the Crown License with Smilley
Donohue Studios AI		AI production tools under the Creator Guarantee
Crown Comics		Publisher of the Crown Universe of heroes

The Crown License and the Smilleys

Donohue Consumer Licensing sells Smilley Corporation the rights to put Donohue characters, films, and brands on toys, clothes, cosmetics, and home goods. That one agreement drives about **41% of Smilley revenue** and only about 0.6% of Donohue's. Donohue is also Smilley's largest outside shareholder. The current license expires at **11:59 PM on Monday, August 31, 2026**. That deadline drives Season 1.

Share Distribution: Donohue Enterprises, Inc. (NYSE: DNHU)

The Donohue Company uses the same kind of **dual-class structure** that controls many real family media empires: the public owns most of the economic value, while the family keeps control through super-voting shares held by a private holding company.

- **Class A common** (NYSE: DNHU): 1 vote per share, publicly traded.
- **Class B common**: 10 votes per share, not traded, 100% owned by Donohue Global Holdings. Converts to Class A if sold outside the family.
- Shares outstanding: 40.0 billion at \$250.00 = \$10.0 trillion market cap.

Holder	Class B (bn)	Class A (bn)	Economic %	Voting %	Value
Donohue Global Holdings, Inc.	9.0	1.0	25.0%	75.2%	\$2,500B
The Donohue Foundation	0.0	1.2	3.0%	1.0%	\$300B
Directors & officers (excl. DGH)	0.0	0.2	0.5%	0.2%	\$50B
Employee stock plans (ESOP & 401k)	0.0	0.8	2.0%	0.7%	\$200B
Index & passive fund managers	0.0	9.6	24.0%	7.9%	\$2,400B
Active institutional investors	0.0	8.4	21.0%	6.9%	\$2,100B
Public pension funds	0.0	2.4	6.0%	2.0%	\$600B
Sovereign wealth funds	0.0	2.0	5.0%	1.7%	\$500B
Retail & other public holders	0.0	5.4	13.5%	4.5%	\$1,350B
TOTAL	9.0	31.0	100%	100%	\$10,000B

RESULT: The family owns 25% of the company's value (\$2.5 trillion, the Donohue family fortune) and controls 75.2% of the vote.

Share Distribution: Donohue Global Holdings, Inc. (private)

Donohue Global Holdings (DGH) is the family's private holding company. It owns all the Class B shares and 1 billion Class A shares, which is 25% of the economic value and 75.2% of the vote. DGH itself is owned by family trusts. Its **votes** are pooled in the **Crown Voting Trust**, set up by Alexander in 1978 at the IPO, so that the family always votes as one bloc.

Owner	Economic %	Value	Voting % (Crown Voting Trust)
Victor Donohue (Victor Donohue Revocable Trust)	26%	\$650B	51%
Joan Donohue (Joan Mercer Donohue Trust)	14%	\$350B	10%

Owner	Economic %	Value	Voting % (Crown Voting Trust)
Natasha Bullock (Natasha Donohue Bullock Trust)	12%	\$300B	15%
Jasmine Olson (Jasmine Donohue Olson Trust)	12%	\$300B	12%
Alvin Donohue (Alvin Donohue Trust)	8%	\$200B	5%
Theodore Donohue Family Trust	8%	\$200B	0%
Marc-Anthony Bullock (Dynasty Trust, sub-trust)	8%	\$200B	7%
Martin Olson (Dynasty Trust, sub-trust)	4%	\$100B	0%
Elxa Jackson (Dynasty Trust, sub-trust)	2%	\$50B	0%
Grace Bullock (Dynasty Trust, sub-trust)	2%	\$50B	0%
Mallory Olson (Dynasty Trust, sub-trust)	2%	\$50B	0%
The Donohue Foundation	2%	\$50B	0%
TOTAL	100%	\$2,500B	100%

Rules that drive the drama

- **The Chairman's Share.** The Chairman of The Donohue Company serves as sole trustee of the Crown Voting Trust and personally votes the 51% bloc.
- **Section 7 of the Alexander Charter.** The sitting Chairman may designate the next trustee. If he dies without a designation, trusteeship passes to the eldest child. That's Jasmine, and after her, Martin.
- **The 1976 Stripping.** When Victor was made CEO, Alexander converted Theodore's branch to economic-only units: 8% of the money and 0% of the vote. Theodore has contested it privately for fifty years.
- **The Dynasty Trust.** The third generation holds economic units only, except Marc-Anthony, whom Victor gave 7% of the vote on January 5, 2026, the first grandchild with a vote.
- **Alvin's children.** Under the Charter, any biological child of a Donohue trust holder becomes a Dynasty Trust beneficiary. Every paternity claim against Alvin is a claim on the fortune.
- **Victor's 80th (Saturday, May 30, 2026).** Victor planned to announce his Section 7 designation that night. He collapsed before he could say the name.

Net worth check (as of January 5, 2026)

Person	DGH stake	Other holdings	Approx. net worth
Victor Donohue	\$650B	Real estate, art, Broadway royalties	~\$680B
Joan Donohue	\$350B	Film royalties, jewels	~\$365B
Natasha Bullock	\$300B	CEO compensation, film & music royalties	~\$330B
Jasmine Olson	\$300B		~\$305B (with Peter's fortune, far more)

Person	DGH stake	Other holdings	Approx. net worth
Marc-Anthony Bullock	\$200B	58% of BSI (\$754B), personal investments (\$40B+)	\$994B+, rising daily
Martin Olson	\$100B		~\$104B